First News

20 April 2026 Friday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

damarketsec.com

Global, Regional Markets

Stock futures tumble, oil surges as Iran developments rekindle uncertainty

Gold & Silver are maintaining an upward trend, often serving as "safe-haven" assets during periods of geopolitical uncertainty Gold is trading near record levels at $4,879.60, up nearly 1.5%. Industrial metals like copper also show modest gains

The sharp decline in oil prices (WTI down over 11%) follows a period of extreme volatility driven by conflict in the Middle East. Prices have cooled significantly—dropping from highs near $120

The Senate Banking Committee holds a confirmation hearing for Kevin Warsh, nominated by President Donald Trump to lead the Federal Reserve.

- Appointed by George W. Bush, he became the youngest-ever Fed Governor at age 35. His assets worth between $135 million and $226 million, which would likely make him the wealthiest Fed Chair in U.S. history. He is married to Jane Lauder, an heiress to the Estée Lauder fortune.
- President Trump said his special envoy Steve Witkoff is traveling to Pakistan for talks with Iran on Tuesday Witkoff has served as theUS special envoy to the Middle East, special envoy for peace missions. He has also acted as a de facto envoy to Russian president Vladimir Putin

President Trump said the Navy stopped and boarded an Iranian-flagged cargo ship in the Gulf of Oman, “blowing a hole” in its engine room after it ignored warnings to stop.

damarketsec.com

Global, Regional Markets

OVER THE WEEKEND

S&P 500 and Nasdaq closed at fresh record highs as stocks rallied on easing Middle East tensions. Optimism over the Strait of Hormuz reopening pushed investors into risk assets, while oil & European natural gas prices tumbled on expectations of smoother energy supply flows.

The Strait Of Hormuz has not been fully normalized, with conflicting reports about reopening and renewed closures leading to cautious shipping activities. U.S. & Asian futures are up while Crude & Brent Oil are experiencing a decline.

April 18: Iran reversed its decision, reimposing strict controls and restrictions on transit. Tehran stated this was in response to the U.S. refusing to lift its own naval blockade on Iranian ports, which remains in place, including clarity on Iran's nuclear program.

- April 17: Iran announced it would open the strait to all commercial vessels, conditional on the continuation of a 10-day ceasefire in Lebanon that began the previous day.

Bitcoin trades above $77,000 after Iran opens Strait Of Hormuz

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	4/17/2026	4/20/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	48,579	49,447	1.79%
S&P 500	7,041	7,126	1.20%
NASDAQ	24,103	24,468	1.52%
PCOMP	5,972	5,972	0.00%
NKY	58,475	58,475	0.00%
SHCOMP	4051	4051	0.00%
HSI	26,160	26,160	0.00%
KOSPI	6191	6191	0.00%
SENSEX	78,493	78,493	0.00%
TWSE	36,804	36,804	0.00%
ASX200	8946	8946	0.00%
BURSAKLCI	1695	1695	0.00%
JCI	7634	7634	0.00%
STI	4997	4997	0.00%
SET	974	974	0.00%
VNINDEX	1817	1817	0.00%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	4/17/2026	4/20/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	93.06	84.85	-8.82%
Brent Crude	98.01	90.38	-7.78%
Gold (Comex)	4817	4879	1.29%
Silver (Comex)	78.83	82.43	4.57%
Copper (Comex)	610.8	617.35	1.07%
Nickel	8.1261	8.4251	3.68%
Coal	133.55	132.3	-0.94%
Corn	458.5	457.5	-0.22%
Wheat	609.5	599.25	-1.68%
Cocoa	3455	3280	-5.07%
Sugar	13.8	13.48	-2.32%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Strategy

Philippines

6,000 Support Tested:

- Volatility is back.
- With the index slipping 1%, look for technical rebounds in heavily oversold sectors, but keep tight stops as global sentiment remains weak.

SmartWatch
DITO WEB BLOOM AT DHI MER PLUS ICT JFC MER GTACP SECB BDO

MACRO WATCH — BSP April 23 Policy Review

- **Slim Majority of Analysts Expect 25bps Rate Hike to 4.5%; Split Decision in View**
- This follows the off-cycle hold decision in March; inflation accelerated to 4.1% in March — breaching the 2–4% target — from just 2.4% in February, with HSBC's Aris Dacanay noting the length of any tightening cycle depends primarily on how long the Middle East conflict persists.
- **The case for a hike**: centers on the sharp peso depreciation (which amplifies imported inflation), rising inflation expectations, and the risk of second-round price effects spreading beyond fuel into transport fares, food, and rent.
- **The case for a hold:** monetary policy has limited effectiveness against supply-driven inflation, growth is already softening, and hiking could deepen the economic downturn without addressing the root cause. DBS Bank flagged the Philippines as leading ASEAN's hawkish camp, while ING noted Thursday's decision is likely to be "close," maintaining a hold as its base case assuming geopolitical tensions ease near term.
- **Analysis:** A 25bps hike — if delivered — would be the first rate increase since October 2023 and signals a formal end to the easing cycle that began in August 2024. Negative for highly leveraged property developers (MEG, CPG), consumer credit-dependent plays (banks' loan growth), and fixed income. Positive for peso stability and MER (rate hike = lower cost recovery pressure). Watch for BSP statement tone on forward guidance — the key variable for markets.

damarketsec.com

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

5999 -64,56pts., -1.06%

Range 5,996.89-6,069.4

Breadth 86 (+) 100 (-) 67 (unch)

Block Php1.95bn **Volume** 1.087bn
Value Php7.437bn

Share buyback ALI OPM
MEG AGI

52wk H: axlm
52wk L: pal phn pizza

Overbought – redc rock aslag
spnec bncom rrhi dito
Oversold – abs gtcap

Active	Value
ICT	839
BDO	727
BPI	312
ALI	251
MER	245
GTCAP	217
PLUS	209
SM	169
URC	157

X

damarketsec.com

Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$38.362mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$175.075mn
YTD NFB	$5.35mn
FB	3,959,031,807.63
FS	5,662,769,896.20
NFB(S)	-1,703,738,088.57
TOTAL	10,053,431,699.88

Foreign Funds Bought
ew pnb pse ap fph sgp gsmi monde meg mrc rock shng dito ceb mac plus at ogp px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bncom bpi cbc mbt secb dhi acen aslag crec fgen mer mwc mynld pcor scc shlph spnec cnpf delm dnl emi jfc keepr rfm urc imi ac aev agi dmc gtcap jgs ltg sm smc ali areit cpg creit dd filrt mreit preit rcr rlc smph glo tel cnvrg ict bloom web pgold

Friday 4/1726 Overseas Investor Net Buyers EW SLF PSE BLOOM MER PCOR AP GLO APX SCC ROCK LTG MONDE PGOLD MAC

SmartWatch dito dhi at spnec web sgp rlc pxp

	4/17/...	4/20...	%Chg
10yr Bond			
PHL	6.634	6.667	0.50%
US	4.311	4.244	-1.55%
Currency Pair			
USD-JPY	159.08	158.64	-0.28%
USD-PHP	59.995	60.057	0.10%
USD-CNY	6.8223	6.818	-0.06%
EUR-USD	1.1781	1.1765	-0.14%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

iTradeAnalytics 04/17

- S**ell On Strenghth: axlm redc rock aslag spnec bncom rrhi dito Buy On Weakness: abs gtcap pal phn pizza**

JFC 163.60 52w 159.50 -246.0

- **Final dividend of ₱1.33 announced Shareholders will receive a dividend of ₱1.33.**
- Ex-date: 4th May 2026 Payment date: 21st May 2026 Dividend yield will be 2.1%, which is higher than the industry average of 1.4%.

- S**hares Slip 3.5% Despite Blockbuster Global Brand News; Analysts Flag Iran War Sentiment Overhang**
- **J**FC shares closed at ₱163.60 on April 17 — down 3.5% for the week — despite four positive press releases covering Smashburger's SSSG swing from negative mid-teen declines to positive double-digit growth, Compose Coffee's blockbuster Taiwan debut, Highlands Coffee's high double-digit 2025 revenue growth, and Korea FTC approval of the Shabu All Day acquisition; analysts cited geopolitical risk sentiment and passive fund outflows as the key culprits behind the price-fundamentals divergence.
- Attributed the gap to Iran war fears weighing on logistics, raw material, and energy costs — plus secondary risk of franchisees adopting a more tentative investment posture. Regina Capital's Luis Limlingan noted JFC is "certainly trading at a discount with record lows of price-to-earnings."
- Technical support is seen at ₱159 and resistance at ₱175–₱185. Full-year 2025 net income rose 5.4% to ₱10.87 billion on 13% revenue growth to ₱305.11 billion; 2026 guidance of 15%–18% operating profit growth remains intact.
- Stance on JFC: ACCUMULATE — The fundamental case is intact and strengthening; the share price decline is sentiment-driven, not earnings-driven. At record-low P/E, geographic earnings diversification, and 2026 guidance reaffirmed, the risk-reward is compelling. A ceasefire or Hormuz reopening would be a sharp positive catalyst. ₱159 is the line in the sand for tactical buyers.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

FPH 17.78

- BDO’s commitment terms are clear that maintaining the role of Federico R. Lopez (FRL) in the FPH group is critical, such that replacing FRL will trigger defaults in the loan agreements of the FPH group.

BDO

- BDO Unibank, Inc. has issued standby letters of credit (SBLCs) in the amount of PHP9.9 billion and PHP14.85 billion in support of First Gen Corporation’s (First Gen) acquisition of a 33% stake in Prime Hydropower Energy, Inc. (PHEI), a member of the Razon group of companies.

MER

- **STT GDC Philippines Signs 10-Year, 40.5MW Renewable Energy Deal with subsidiary MPower; Data Center Sector Validates Green Energy Demand**
- ST Telemedia Global Data Centres (STT GDC) Philippines — a joint venture among Globe Telecom, Ayala Corp., and Singapore's ST Telemedia — has entered a 10-year renewable energy supply agreement with Meralco's MPower subsidiary, securing 40.5 MW of RE supply for its STT Fairview and STT Cavite data center facilities; MPower holds more than 35% of the competitive retail electricity market within Meralco's franchise area.
- STT GDC Philippines currently operates seven data centers with a combined IT load of 150 MW. The deal supports the company's 2030 carbon-neutral target and comes as AI and cloud demand accelerates the buildout of Philippine digital infrastructure. For MPower, this is a landmark long-term commercial contract that demonstrates the retail electricity market's effectiveness in capturing high-value, energy-intensive GCC and data center tenants — precisely the segment that provides stable, recession-resistant recurring revenue. For GLO and AC (both STT GDC JV partners), the deal validates their data center capex investment thesis.
- **Stance on MER:** ACCUMULATE — MPower's 35%+ market share in competitive retail electricity and growing RE supply portfolio positions it as the Philippines' data center energy partner of choice. This deal is a model for future long-duration, high-volume green energy contracts. Indirect positive for GLO and AC.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PETRON — Petron Corp.

- **Court of Tax Appeals Orders BIR to Refund ₱389.5 Million in Excise Taxes on Aviation Fuel**
- The Court of Tax Appeals partially granted Petron's petition and ordered the BIR to refund ₱389.49 million in excise taxes erroneously paid on Jet A-1 fuel sold to international carriers and tax-exempt entities in 2020, ruling that the Section 135 NIRC exemption benefits the statutory taxpayer — Petron as manufacturer/importer — not merely the carriers who bear the economic burden; the court disallowed ₱197.47 million of the original ₱586.96 million claim due to insufficient documentation.
- The ruling clarifies a long-disputed question of who may claim the Section 135 exemption — a matter with significant industry implications for Petron's ongoing and future refund claims on aviation fuel. Petron's 2025 full-year net income surged 84% to ₱15.6 billion on refinery performance improvements and domestic volume growth. The ₱389.5 million refund, while material, is a one-time item relative to the scale of Petron's revenues (₱810 billion in 2025) and does not alter the fundamental earnings story.
- **Stance on PETRON:** MONITOR — Excellent 2025 earnings base; the CTA ruling is a modest cash flow positive and sets a useful legal precedent for future claims. However, Petron's near-term earnings outlook depends heavily on how long jet fuel and refinery margins remain elevated. Rising fuel prices are a double-edged sword: higher refining margins but also demand destruction. Watch refining margins into Q2 2026.

CEB / PAL — Aviation Sector

- **DoTr Reviews Fuel Surcharges After CAB Moves to Level 8; Level 20 Maximum Cannot Be Ruled Out**
- The Civil Aeronautics Board moved the April 1–15 fuel surcharge to Level 8 — up sharply from Level 4 in March — with domestic surcharges ranging from ₱253 to ₱787 per leg and international surcharges from ₱835 to ₱6,208 depending on distance; the DoTr confirmed it has also shifted from monthly to 15-day surcharge reviews to respond more quickly to jet fuel price movements, noting that other countries have already imposed a Level 20 surcharge — the maximum. At Level 20, domestic passengers would pay ₱661–₱1,933 per leg and international passengers ₱2,183–₱16,232 per leg. Jet fuel prices, per IATA data, fell 5.3% week-on-week to $197.83 per barrel but remain 119.7% above year-ago levels — meaning any weekly moderation provides little structural relief. Acting DoTr Secretary Lopez said the government is "hoping not to reach Level 20."
- Stance on CEB: MONITOR — Fuel surcharge pass-through is a margin protection mechanism, but higher total fares will suppress booking volumes, particularly in the leisure and OFW traveler segments. CEB's 72% NEO fleet provides fuel efficiency, but absolute jet fuel costs at these levels are significant. Watch April load factor data — the first indicator of demand destruction.
- Stance on PAL: MONITOR — Same dynamics apply; PAL's suspension of Dubai/Doha routes until May 31 reduces its Middle East exposure directly.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

GTCAP 500.00

- Federal Land NRE Global (FNG) Bullish on Riverpark Township Despite Global Risks; Capex Rises, New Launches to Wait for Calmer Environment
- FNG President Thomas Mirasol said the company remains bullish on Philippine real estate — backed by structural fundamentals of population growth, urbanization, and a 4–6 million unit housing backlog — with capex for 2026 rising significantly from 2025 levels to continue phased Riverpark development, though new launches will be timed more carefully to demand conditions amid global uncertainties. Mirasol noted no sales slowdown since February, with March performing well and April expected to match or exceed it, while emphasizing that the company will slow development if demand appears uncertain. The 600-hectare Riverpark township in General Trias, Cavite is in early-stage development with UNIQLO's largest Southeast Asian warehouse operational, SM City General Trias targeted for 2026 completion, and Ateneo de Manila University campus expected by 2030. GT Capital recently acquired a direct 20% stake in FNG for ₱9.16 billion, deepening its strategic alignment with Riverpark.
- **Stance on GTC:** ACCUMULATE — FNG's Riverpark is a 30-year mega-township story with exceptional institutional anchors (SM, Ateneo, UNIQLO). The "wait-and-see on new launches" posture is exactly the right capital discipline for the current environment. GTCAP's direct stake acquisition at ₱9.16 billion reinforces conviction in the long-term value of the asset.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

DGTL / PLUS

- **ArenaPlus Joins Sportradar's Global Integrity Exchange; Compliance Infrastructure Strengthened Ahead of International Expansion**
- DigiPlus has integrated its ArenaPlus sportsbook brand into Sportradar's Integrity Exchange (SIE) — a real-time global intelligence network linking betting operators across markets to share alerts on suspicious betting patterns and detect potential match-fixing — with the AI-driven Universal Fraud Detection System and expert analysis complementing the data-sharing infrastructure.
- The SIE integration was originally announced in March and positions ArenaPlus as a credible international-standard sportsbook ahead of its planned entry into Brazil (H1 2026) and South Africa (early 2027). Regulatory scrutiny of online gaming is intensifying globally; demonstrating integrity infrastructure is now a licensing prerequisite in most mature markets. For DigiPlus, the Sportradar partnership is both a compliance investment and a competitive differentiator as it seeks operational licenses in new markets.
- **Stance on DGTL:** ACCUMULATE — The compliance infrastructure build-out (Sportradar/SIE) directly supports the South Africa and Brazil licensing narratives. Investors in DGTL's international growth story should view this as de-risking rather than just cost. Domestic recovery from the Q3 e-wallet delinking impact will be the near-term earnings catalyst to monitor.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

FRUIT

- **Targets 20% Revenue Growth in 2026; Absorbs Fuel Cost Increases to Hold Consumer Price Points**
- Fruitas Holdings is targeting at least 20% revenue growth in 2026 — significantly outpacing the IMF's 4.1% Philippine GDP forecast — backed by a ₱120 million capex program allocating ₱90 million for 100 new locations, ₱20 million for commissary upgrades, and ₱10 million for logistics; the company will absorb rising fuel costs from its fleet of ~200 vehicles rather than passing them to consumers, using institutional sales and export market diversification through its Jamaican Patty and Ling Nam brands to sustain momentum. Fruitas operated 858 stores as of end-2025 on a low-price, mass-market model that is structurally resilient in an inflationary environment — consumers trading down from sit-down dining naturally migrate to kiosk and community store formats. The price-holding decision is a bold bet on volume-driven growth and market share expansion when competitors may be forced to raise prices.\
- **Stance on FRUIT:** ACCUMULATE — The mass-market food and beverage model is a natural beneficiary of consumer discretionary spending compression. Absorbing fuel costs is margin-dilutive short-term but competitively astute in building foot traffic. A 20% revenue growth target in a sub-5% GDP environment speaks to a company taking market share, not just riding the cycle. Watch Q1 2026 revenue disclosure for early validation.

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/16/2026	4/17/2026	%Chg
AC	514	502.5	-2.24%
ACEN	3	3	0.00%
AEV	30	30	0.00%
ALI	17.3	17.2	-0.58%
AREIT	40.2	40.05	-0.37%
BDO	118.6	119.5	0.76%
BPI	100.7	99.2	-1.49%
CBC	64	63.65	-0.55%
CNPF	31.5	32	1.59%
CNVRG	11.96	12.14	1.51%
DMC	10.14	10.04	-0.99%
EMI	15.4	15.3	-0.65%
GLO	1,655.00	1,645.00	-0.60%
GTCAP	495	500	1.01%
ICT	715	709.5	-0.77%
JFC	164.5	163.6	-0.55%
JGS	26.35	26.9	2.09%

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	4/16/2026	4/17/2026	%Chg
LTG	15.2	15.02	-1.18%
MBT	69.35	67.5	-2.67%
MER	646	632	-2.17%
MONDE	6.91	6.89	-0.29%
PGOLD	43	41.8	-2.79%
PLUS	14.98	15.06	0.53%
RCR	7.04	6.98	-0.85%
SCC	30.2	30.15	-0.17%
SM	634	610	-3.79%
SMC	72	71.95	-0.07%
SMPH	20.2	20	-0.99%
TEL	1,278.00	1,271.00	-0.55%
URC	61.75	61	-1.21%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	4/16/2026	4/17/2026	%Chg
AREIT	40.2	40.05	-0.37%
CBC	64	63.65	-0.55%
CREIT	3.55	3.55	0.00%
DMC	10.14	10.04	-0.99%
DNL	3.7	3.72	0.54%
GLO	1,655.00	1,645.00	-0.60%
LTG	15.2	15.02	-1.18%
MBT	69.35	67.5	-2.67%
MER	646	632	-2.17%
MREIT	13.86	13.8	-0.43%
NIKL	4.84	4.84	0.00%
OGP	35.35	35.25	-0.28%
PGOLD	43	41.8	-2.79%
RCR	7.04	6.98	-0.85%
RLC	17.4	17.42	0.11%
RRHI	46.2	46.05	-0.32%
SCC	30.2	30.15	-0.17%
SGP	22	22.1	0.45%
TEL	1,278.00	1,271.00	-0.55%
URC	61.75	61	-1.21%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	4/16/2026	4/17/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.68	9.4	-2.89%
APX	17.46	17.46	0.00%
AUB	42.05	42.5	1.07%
BLOOM	2.03	2.09	2.96%
COSCO	6.97	6.95	-0.29%
DNL	3.7	3.72	0.54%
GSMI	271	275	1.48%
KEEPR	2.12	2.07	-2.36%
MEG	2.09	2.09	0.00%
MREIT	13.86	13.8	-0.43%
MWC	43.5	43.5	0.00%
NIKL	4.84	4.84	0.00%
OGP	35.35	35.25	-0.28%
PNB	60.45	60.5	0.08%
RLC	17.4	17.42	0.11%
RRHI	46.2	46.05	-0.32%
SECB	68	67.5	-0.74%
SEVN	33	33.95	2.88%
SGP	22	22.1	0.45%
WLCON	6.15	6.1	-0.81%